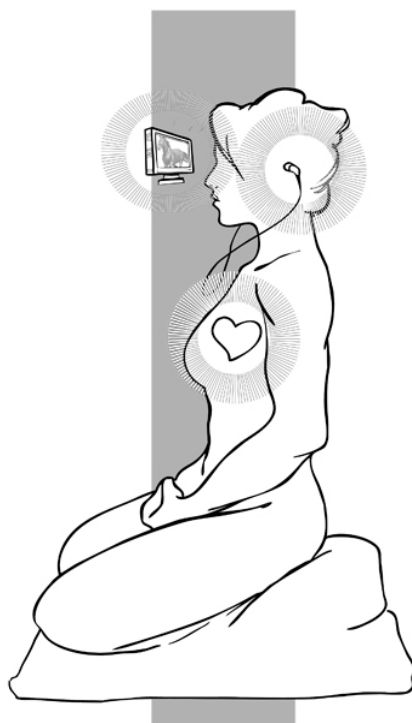


See Hear Feel: An Introduction



In 2016, Basic Mindfulness was renamed “Unified Mindfulness.”

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Preface: Introducing See Hear Feel

This article is an introduction to one of the standard techniques in Unified Mindfulness (formerly Basic Mindfulness). The technique is called See Hear Feel.

Like MBSR, Unified Mindfulness is a modern, evidence-based system of mindfulness. The principles that underlie its structure are described in the document entitled *What is Mindfulness?*

See Hear Feel is a form of noting. There are many other ways to do noting (i.e., the classical Mahasi system which is the original inspiration for See Hear Feel). In the Unified Mindfulness system, mindful awareness is defined quite broadly: concentration power, sensory clarity, and equanimity working together. From that broad perspective, any practice that, with time, elevates your base level of those skills counts as a mindful awareness practice. So techniques like Nurture Positive and even Do Nothing can be considered mindful awareness practices.

Spoken or mental labels are options within the process of noting, just like first gear and second gear are options within the process of driving. In this article I talk a lot about labeling before actually saying much about noting, but there's a reason for that. Anyone can learn how to label sensory events. When you label properly you have, by definition, enough concentration, clarity, and equanimity for the noting to be effective. Once you get a taste of what that state is like, you'll probably be able to reproduce it even without the labels. If not, you can always go back to using the labels.

So the labels perform two functions. First, they train you to recognize what it's like to be in a basic level of mindfulness. Second, if you're running into a challenge, all you need to do is go back to labeling in order to reestablish that basic level of mindfulness.

Here's a Venn diagram that clarifies some basic relationships:

